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Biggest myths about women in tech?



Snehal Meshram, Amazon

One of the common stereotypes, as women start climbing the career ladder, is that most leadership roles in tech involve long and laborious hours and are best suited for men. Or that, when faced with a situation of a new born child in the family, the woman is better suited to reduce their working hours as men are not equipped to support the child. Corporate entities and leaders are accountable to create equitable working environments considering these constraints.



Kavitha Prasad, Intel

Ambition in women is sometimes misconstrued as being aggressive. Silence in women is often misinterpreted as weakness. Or our passion is sometimes mistaken for misplaced emotions.



**Jaya Singh,
Texas Instruments**

Even as young women choose to pursue their passion in STEM, they are often deterred by stereotypical views. For example, many still think that semiconductor engineering is more apt for men. We need to break out of these cultural notions that have been, consciously and unconsciously, imprinted upon us for generations. We need to stop defining roles based on stereotypes of masculinity and femininity and see people for who they are and what they are capable of.



Sumati Sahgal, Lenovo

Most bizarre myths I've heard: women aren't tech-savvy and have worse technical skills than their male counterparts. It is presumed their EQ is better than their analytical understanding, hence, their technical aptitude is bad. Women themselves feel a male dominance in certain frontend roles like sales and shy away from them, further strengthening the vicious circle.



Kaveri Jain, Micron

To develop leaders, mentorship alone is not enough. So often, women tend to be over-mentored and not sponsored. I believe that while mentoring emerging leaders and being their sounding board is important, we must also be their biggest and loudest advocates when they are not in the room. The balance of these two areas is crucial when developing strong leaders.